

"The Three Little Pigs" Game Design Activity

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Objective(s)

Students will analyze the classic fairy tale "The Three Little Pigs" and reimagine it as a video game. They will learn to break down a narrative into key elements like game mechanics, rules, and reward systems, and collaborate to design and present their game concept.

Materials Needed

- Copies of "The Three Little Pigs" or a summary of the story
- Whiteboard/Smartboard for brainstorming
- Paper and pencils for note-taking and design sketches

Introduction to Game Design Concepts

1. What is Game Design?

- Game design involves creating the content and rules of a game, as well as the gameplay experience. It combines creativity with logic to make engaging and fun games.

2. Key Concepts in Game Design:

- **Mechanics:** The basic actions, processes, or controls that players use to interact with the game. For example, jumping, running, and collecting items are common mechanics in many games.
- **Rules:** The guidelines that define how a game is played, including what is allowed or not allowed. Rules ensure that the game is fair and challenging.
- **Reward Systems:** The ways a game incentivizes players to keep playing, such as earning points, unlocking new levels, or gaining power-ups. Rewards motivate players by giving them a sense of achievement.

3. Examples in Popular Games:

- **Mechanics:** In "Super Mario," mechanics include jumping on enemies and collecting coins.
- **Rules:** In "Chess," each piece has specific rules about how it can move.
- **Reward Systems:** In "Minecraft," players are rewarded by unlocking new materials and tools as they gather resources and build.

Activity 1: Analyzing "The Three Little Pigs" as a Game

1. Story Overview:

- Briefly recap the story of "The Three Little Pigs." Discuss the key events: the pigs building houses, the wolf trying to blow them down, and the final outcome where the brick house withstands the wolf's huffing and puffing.

2. Discussion:

- Ask students to think about how this story could be turned into a video game.
- What parts of the story could become game mechanics?
- What challenges and rules could the game have?

3. Group Brainstorming:

- Divide students into small groups and give them the following tasks:
 - Identify the main characters (e.g., the pigs, the wolf) and the setting.
 - Discuss possible mechanics. For example:
 - Building houses (perhaps through a mini-game where players gather materials and construct different types of houses).
 - Avoiding or confronting the wolf (e.g., running, hiding, setting traps).
 - Consider the rules. How many lives do players have? What happens if the wolf catches a pig? What are the objectives of the game?
 - Think about reward systems. What rewards could motivate players? For example, earning better building materials, unlocking new levels, or gaining special abilities.

Activity 2: Game Design Workshop

1. Design the Game:

- Each group should now design their version of "The Three Little Pigs" as a video game. They should outline:
 - **Game Objective:** What is the player trying to achieve? (e.g., successfully building the strongest house, outsmarting the wolf)
 - **Game Mechanics:** List and describe the main actions players will take.
 - **Rules:** Define the rules of the game. How does the game start and end? What are the challenges?
 - **Reward System:** Decide how players are rewarded. What motivates them to keep playing?

2. Create a Game Pitch:

- After designing their game, each group will prepare a short presentation (3-5 minutes) to pitch their game concept to the rest of the class. They should explain how their game works and what makes it fun and engaging.

Presentations and Feedback

1. Group Presentations:

- Each group presents their game design to the class.
- Each group explains each part of their game, focusing on the:
 - narrative
 - mechanics
 - rules
 - rewards

2. Class Feedback:

- After each presentation, allow time for questions and feedback from the other students.
- What do they like about the game?
- What could be improved?

Wrap-Up and Reflection

1. Recap Key Points:

- Review the concepts of mechanics, rules, and rewards.
- Discuss how these elements came into play during the design activity.

2. Reflect on the Process:

- Ask students to reflect on what they learned from turning a story into a game.
 - What was challenging?
 - What was fun?
 - How does thinking like a game designer change the way they see stories and games?